

Summary of Lessons Learned and Future Actions as a Result of South Africa
Conference and Field visits from Jan 25th – Feb 18th, 2010.
Chandeep Corea

NOTE: Following is listed chronologically and is meant as a summary. Links to any detailed docs are included.

Dates/Act	Contacts	Lessons	Future Actions
ivity			
Jan 25-29th IEF Conference – Elephants for Africa	Dr. Kate Evans (Head) kate@elephantsforafrica.org Simon Buckingham Mphoeng	* Collected small DB of ele's for eleID testing.	*They will modify their protocols to utilize eleID. *Results emailed to them on March 1st. *If visiting Botswana for other work we should be able to collaborate on some community HEC with them.
Jan 25-29th IEF Conference – Zambezi Elephant Trails	Clover King zamelephants@afpar.com		*Follow up on eleAlert once testing is done
Jan 25-29th IEF Conference – all attendees	elePortal	* need to launch for all elephants and as previously thought there needs to be data in the database *need to launch as www.elePortal.info not AsianElephant.info	*contact Debbie to get all abstracts submitted to IEF 2010 and previous (accepted and not accepted) and find volunteer to enter info into DB. *Plan official launch for next IEF
Jan 25-29th IEF Conference – all attendees	eleID	*online/offline *customizable for research groups *testing protocols *	*eleID team and UoM informed and these are now included in work plan.
Jan 25-29th IEF Conference – South African attendees	eleAlert	*not much interest in SA due to the fact that there fencing is for all game and are very well patrolled and maintained.	
Jan 25-29th	Chester Zoo	British independent volunteers follow up with her for funding	

IEF A.Zimmermann from the Zoo for mini-projects
Conferenc @chesterzoo.org with us.

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–Alexande

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Zimmerm
an

Jan chris@bornfree. eleID – contact for similar project
25-29th org.uk –

IEF Ian Redmond OBE
Conferenc Ambassador, UN Year of the
e – Gorilla
Chris Chief Consultant, GRASP -
Draper UNEP/UNESCO Great Ape
Survival Partnership
c/o RSPCA Building
Lansdown
STROUD
Glos. GL5 1BG, UK

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Feb 1-3rd **Safann Mac**
-GVI **Carthy**
Karangua Expedition
we Manager
South Africa
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3866

See
<http://docs.google.com/Doc?docid=0AdCLDwkEthlHZGRqODcyNmdfNDdkZHhyYzRnYw&hl=en>
for details

1. To reiterate that however repetitive and boring work may be it is essential that there is always work and it fits as much of a schedule as possible.
2. Cleanliness and organization at field site (at least in common areas). Everything must be labeled and set in place and EVERYONE (especially SLWCS Team)
3. Whenever someone comes to site the volunteers should be told beforehand to expect x team who are not necessary but mention.

8. We need to speak to GVI about getting there volunteers in Asia and Africa to collect and submit photos for eleID.

9. Depending on work in Botswana –we should look at working with GVI on doing some HEC surveys (there volunteers do it based on our training). There was some interest in this additional activity and it will help us develop a good DB of conflict around both regions at almost no cost to us beyond developing the methods (already have and just needs to be slightly modified for each site) and centralizing the info/analyzing it.

10. Need to look at the “Expedition” rather than “Project” model for doing the

4. Daily debriefings are necessary. Just 2-3 mins at end of each day.
 5. Safety in vehicles and not having anything protruding like the nails in the softop LR. These vehicles were old but well maintained even though they had duties as rough as our vehicles.
 6. Giving data entry, clean up and maintenance chores to volunteers is ok as long as it is well planned and everyone is given similar work to do, for similar periods during their stay.
 7. Planned work should happen despite vehicle breakdowns. For ex. One of the vehicles broke down during our stay and they hired another vehicle so that the work could be done as planned with only a short delay.
- Kalpitiya and Eastern Coast work (plus OT but volunteers can't be used for community surveys (in the long term) and we need to have BD research. The surveys can happen every Quarter for example with a 5 week program where they do survey based at a site. It would be for min say 6 people and up to 15. Staff/Activities can be increased based on sign up and we have experience with this model and the first KKP surveys.

Feb 4th Save the Elephants	Dr Michelle Henley michelephant@worldonline.co.za +27157930369	*eleID – Database of 8gb with annotated elephants from Timbavati/Kruger project site going back over 8 years *Contacts for eleAlert with sanPARKS but could not meet them due to schedule (and frankly they did not seem very interested). Sam Ferriera (Scientist of Large Mammal Community Processes and Species of Concern) +27137354189 or +27766004152, samf@sanparks.org *Contact for --Ken Furguson - Selousgame@hotmail.com work on visual community systems for fences in NE of Kruger (could not contact) *Interesting papers on GIS and	*Allows testing of software for how it handles age variation and color variation. *Need GPS locations for images...will be requested once base testing is done.
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Camera Trapping. See picture/video log.
 *Well set up tented camp (for field researchers and hotels and good integration).
 *Collected some papers on fence-interface research, GIS and Community Conservation from the SA National Parks –annual "Science Networking" meeting.

Feb 4th
 Timbavati
 Private
 Game
 Reserve

Feb 5th	Rory Hensman	*Ability to train ele's for landmine/poacher detection (basically anything based on smell)	*As they are shutting down operations they maybe very good to get down to train local mahouts on more interactive elephant presentations and for training ele's for use in tourism.
Elephants for Africa Forever (EFAF)	rory.lindie@gmail.com +27836787115	*Interesting way of showing visitors how good elephant memory is *Formula for elephant feed pellets and Bana grass NOTES on Bana:	

*it is susceptible to frost!
 *cut the bana grass for the cattle, horses and elephant. This way we can monitor it and make sure it has enough time to grow properly.
 *developed by the Zimbabwe CSIR in the Matopos as a good fodder for animals and it is a sorghum / millet hybrid cross.

Feb 5-6th	Sean Hensman	*Most informative and well done elephant biology presentation seen.	*This is linked to EFAF (father-son)
Elephant Whisperers Hazyzy View	Andre andre@elephantwhispers.co.za	*Well layed out facilities	

Feb 6-7th	(tourism visit) as Kruger	Well layed out facilities which are not ideal but probably the best way to handle the numbers of visitors with min. impact to the	Good footage of wilddogs and facilities
	contacts were not available at last minute.		

		environment apart from restricting visitor numbers.	
Feb 8th-9th	Dr. Patrick Researcher – Grahamstown University sipabina@gmail.com +27734158400	eleID	Worked on image noise reduction formula and will assist in similar work needed for eleID
Feb 9th-10th	WWE Quinton Gillson quinton@worldwideexperience.com South Africa Program Manager +27728901988	*Very good volunteer facilities (private double rooms with bathrooms). *All meals cooked by staff *Volunteers work as a large group (even when not necessary) and are mostly responsible for maintenance *work only from 8am to 5pm except in a few cases *	*If facilities and fun are good then work is not important as long as the story is given well. *Activities need to be on time and explained well *Manual work is ok as long as it is explained well and people feel that it is important – i.e use them on the farm for a few days
Feb 10th	Born Free Foundation Animal Rescue and Education Centre	*Good/v. Informative education center. *Maybe best avenue to set up a Safari Park in Sri Lanka by styling it as a rescue centre rather than getting good animals from Zoo's.	
Feb 10-11th	Jordana Meyer Megaherbivore Research Coordinator Lincoln Park Zoo-Conservation & Science Addo Elephant National Park PO Box 52 Addo 6105 South Africa Tel: +27848684899 Email: jordanameyer@gmail.com	*use of the capture cameras (video and still) –SM/CW remind me to show you my video log on this. *Over 200 elephants at one waterhole –interesting to look at how much damage they are doing. <i>The one plant you collect was spekboom: Portulacaria afra, also known as dwarf jade, elephant's food, or elephant bush, is a small-leaved succulent popular as an indoor bonsai and as a hardy xeriscaping plant. It is common in the East of South Africa, and is known as "Spekboom" in Afrikaans.</i>	*Collected Portulacaria afra sprig for planting as Ele's and humans use it –so possibly good mixed use crop. *Shared GIS methodology and process

Feb 11-12th Plattenburg Bay Centre for Dolphin Studies An Independent Research and Educational Institute

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V.G. Cockcroft
Coordinator: Mrs
van den Heever
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865158319
Mobile/Cell: 27
(0)83 655 6902
www.dolphinstitutes.org
SKYPE: C.D.S.1

Feb 12th Plattenburg Bay Primate Land Birds of Eden

Feb 11-12th Plattenburg Bay ORCA -Tracey WWE Program 0829627153

Feb 12-13 Knysna Elephant Park
Tel: +27 (0) 44 532 7732
Fax: +27 (0) 44 532 7763
www.knysnaelephantpark.co.za
*Greg
-+27832904141
* Dr. Debbie D. Young
AFRICAN ELEPHANT RESEARCH UNIT (AERU)

*Amazingly well organized program with highlight being rooms and lounge that overlook the elephant barn
*Elephants are free to roam duringso much damage.
day and visitors are taken to where they are in the facility and each group has a guide who individually goes over the aspects of elephant life that the guests are interested in. So it is very tailored to their needs.
*Elephants do not have a single mahout. They work with/know all the “guides” and senior staff.

*The SA and Zimbabwean guides simply did not understand how SL communities still want to keep wild elephants when they do

Cell: +27 (0) 83 655 6903 *Ele's are "rescued" from other facilities or orphaned.
email: research@kynsnaelephantpark.co.za

Feb 14-16th Gans Bay
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Tracey Fourie
Marine Dynamics - Volunteer Programme
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Marine Dynamics Shark Tours
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Email: bookings@whalewatchsa.com
www.sharkwatchsa.com

Feb 16-18th Harmanus-Cape Town & Coledon